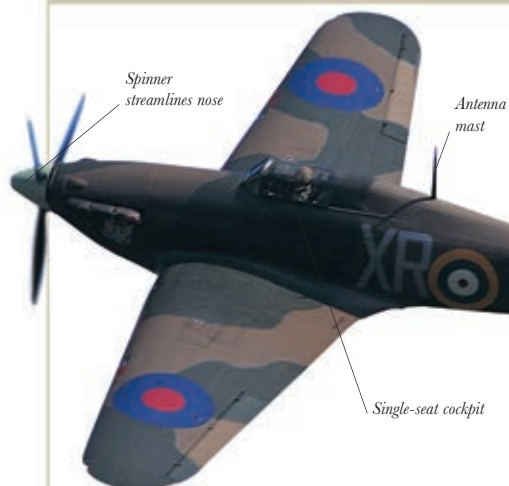


Hawker Hurricane IIB



The RAF's first monoplane fighter entered service in 1937. Rather than its more glamorous counterpart, the Spitfire, it was the RAF's principal fighter in the Battle of Britain. There were 32 Hurricane squadrons during the Battle, compared with 19 equipped with Spitfires. Hurricanes shot down more aircraft than all other defenses – air and ground – combined. Later, when it was outclassed as a fighter, the Hurricane served in ground attack and “tankbuster” roles. Shipborne versions protected merchant convoys.

ENGINE 1,260hp Rolls-Royce Merlin XX liquid-cooled V-12 cylinder
WINGSPAN 40ft (12.1m) **LENGTH** 32ft 2in (9.8m)
TOP SPEED 340mph (544kph) **CREW** 1
ARMAMENT 12 x .303in Browning machine guns; 2 x 250lb (114kg) or 500lb (227kg) bombs, or 8 rocket projectiles

Hawker Typhoon IB

Designed to have twice the power of the previous generation of British fighters, the Typhoon was rushed into production in 1941 and suffered a series of structural and engine failures. Worse was the fact that its performance at high altitude was poor. However, it was extremely fast at low level and, with its heavy armament, proved to be a devastating ground attack aircraft, playing a valuable “tank-busting” role during the 1944 Normandy landings.

ENGINE 2,180hp Napier Sabre II liquid-cooled H-24 cylinder
WINGSPAN 41ft 7in (12.7m) **LENGTH** 31ft 11in (9.7m)
TOP SPEED 412mph (664kph) **CREW** 1
ARMAMENT 4 x 20mm Hispano cannon; 8 rocket projectiles or 2 x 500lb (227kg) bombs under wings



Hawker Tempest V



The Tempest, in service from 1944, was the aircraft the Typhoon should have been. Using the same engine but with a new, thinner wing, it had excellent high-altitude fighting characteristics. It was also very fast – one of the few aircraft able to catch and destroy a V-1 flying bomb, as well as achieving successes against Me 262 jet fighters over Germany in 1945.

ENGINE 2,180hp Napier Sabre II liquid-cooled H-24 inline
WINGSPAN 41ft (12.5m) **LENGTH** 33ft 8in (10.3m)
TOP SPEED 427mph (688kph) **CREW** 1
ARMAMENT 4 x 20mm Hispano cannon, 8 rocket projectiles or 2 x 500lb (227kg) bombs under wings

Henschel Hs 129B-1/R2

The Hs 129 was a ground attack aircraft with an armored cockpit and very heavy armament, designed to destroy tanks. The first model was grossly underpowered, and, as no other German engines were available, it was equipped with engines from Vichy France after 1940. These were unreliable and vulnerable to battle damage. The aircraft operated with some success on the Eastern Front, after being fitted with 37mm, and, even the huge 75mm antitank guns, in an effort to counter the thickly armored Russian tanks.



ENGINE 2 x 700hp Gnome-Rhone 14M 4/5 14-cylinder radials
WINGSPAN 46ft 7in (14.2m) **LENGTH** 32ft (9.8m)
TOP SPEED 253mph (407kph) **CREW** 1
ARMAMENT 2 x 7.9mm MG17 machine guns, 2 x 20mm MG151 cannon, 1 x 30mm MK101 cannon

Ilyushin Il-2 M3 Shturmovik

The Shturmovik or armored attack aircraft was a unique Soviet design and played a decisive role on the Eastern Front, with over 37,000 built. The armour-plated fuselage enclosed the engine, pilot, and fuel, allowing it to attack German tanks through a hail of small arms fire.



ENGINE 1,750hp Mikulin AM-38F liquid-cooled V-12 cylinder
WINGSPAN 47ft 11in (14.6m) **LENGTH** 38ft 11in (11.6m)
TOP SPEED 251mph (404kph) **CREW** 2
ARMAMENT 2 x 23mm cannon, 2 x 7.62mm and 1 x 12.7mm machine guns; 8 rockets or 1,323lb (600kg) bombload

Junkers Ju 87D-5

The German technique of armored warfare involved close support of the tanks by dive-bombers (“Stukas”). This contributed to the success of *Blitzkrieg* in Poland, France, and, initially, in Russia, and the Ju 87 was regarded as a wonder weapon. But it was slow and vulnerable on the way to its target and modern fighters could easily destroy it. Ju 87s were hastily withdrawn from the Battle of Britain, after whole formations were shot down. As the Allies gained air superiority, the Stuka became increasingly ineffective.



ENGINE 1,400hp Junkers Jumo 211J-1 liquid-cooled V-12 cylinder
WINGSPAN 49ft 3in (15m) **LENGTH** 73ft 9in (22.5m)
TOP SPEED 255mph (411kph) **CREW** 2
ARMAMENT 2 x 20mm MG 151/20, 1 x 7.9mm MG 81Z; 1,800lb (4,000kg) bombload